SHANNON SPENCE

Independent Cartoonist & Artist ✦ Printmaker ✦ Community organizer

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SELF-PUBLISHED WORKS

2023-2024	**P*NK LAB GRL! (Punk Lab Girl)** ~ Sci-fi lite, anti-capitalist monster manifesto sprouting from a career in lab science starting in the pandemic. Self-organized book release and east coast tour.
2022	**Kid Internet: Connect** ~ Nostalgic memoir about growing up online in the early 2000's,
2023-2025	**CART Zine** ~ Variety zine published in risograph and mailed to subscribers on Patreon. Featured my own comics, guest work and interviews all focused on different topics in art and gaming.

SELECTED PROJECTS & LEADERSHIP

2022–present	**Comix Accountability Club ~ Founder** ~ Founded and run an inclusive cartoonist community; organize online and in-person programming, collaborative anthologies, workshops, retreats, and mini-grants. comixaccountability.club
2022–present	**Independent Cartoonist & Publisher** ~ Create, print, distribute, and sell original comics and zines through festivals, shops, and direct sales; organize readings and releases; speak at panels and workshops.
2025	**CART Press ~ Co-founder** ~ Developed a DIY small-press printing venture specializing in comics, zines, and creative production methods.
2025–2026	**CAC Retreat ~ Organizer** ~ Organized an artist gathering and collaborative programming in Shepherdstown, WV.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

2020	**Virginia Commonwealth University** ~ MS, Clinical Laboratory Science (Microbiology)
2019	**University of Virginia** ~ BA, Biology & Fine Art (Printmaking); Miller Arts Scholar
2017–2025	**Clinical Microbiology & Medical Research** ~ Medical technologist, microbiology section supervisor, and research assistant at CarePoint Health System, VCU Health, and UVA Health.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

2026	**Special Guest** ~ Norfolk Indie Comics Expo (NOICE), Norfolk, VA
2025	**Artist of the Month** ~ Riso Inc.
2024	**Mini-Grant Recipient** ~ Comics Advocacy Group
2022	**Best Comic Zine Finalist** ~ Broken Pencil Magazine Awards

EXHIBITIONS & PERFORMANCES

2025	**Trash & Other Filth** ~ Group exhibition and live performance as Mutagen, Dwightmess Gallery, MD
2024-2025	**Comic Readings** ~ Frog Farm 9 and Secret Third Thing (Brooklyn); Distractor (Columbus); Exclamation Point (Philadelphia); Pizza Party Pizza Party (Brooklyn); Bug Milk (Toronto)

SELECTED FAIRS & FESTIVALS

2026	**TCAF • Philadelphia Comics Expo • Denver Comic and Arts Festival**
2025	**MoCCA • Cartoon Crossroads Columbus • Pittsburgh Indie Comics Expo • Philly Zine Fest**
2024	**Small Press Expo • CAKE • Short Run • TCAF**